

SKY CHARTS

THE SIX CHARTS ON THE FOLLOWING PAGES COVER THE WHOLE CELESTIAL SPHERE; ONE FOR EACH OF THE NORTH AND SOUTH POLAR REGIONS, AND FOUR FOR THE BELT OF SKY BETWEEN.

Visibility, magnitude, and distance

Each constellation has a data panel, which gives key information about the constellation, including the latitudes from where it is fully visible, and the months when it is highest in the sky. Each of the main stars has a brightness symbol together with its apparent magnitude, and a distance symbol with its distance from Earth in light-years.



Constellation chart key

The individual constellation charts show each main star of the constellation, including the stars that make up its pattern and other notable stars. The apparent magnitude (brightness) of the stars is indicated by the key shown right. The charts also include key deep-sky objects, such as galaxies, nebulae, and star clusters, the symbols for which are also shown in the key on the right.

Star magnitudes Deep-sky objects

Star magnitudes	Deep-sky objects
—1.5–0	Diffuse nebula
0–0.9	Planetary nebula, nova, nova remnant, or supernova remnant
1.0–1.9	
2.0–2.9	Galaxy or quasar
3.0–3.9	
4.0–4.9	Black hole, X-ray source, or neutron star
5.0–5.9	
6.0–6.9	Globular star cluster
7.0–7.9	Open star cluster

Together, the six charts show the entire sky surrounding Earth and the location of all 88 constellations. The two circular maps shown here are each centered on a celestial pole. The other four maps on the following pages cover the equatorial regions; each is centered on a quarter of the celestial equator. Individual constellations are profiled in the pages following the maps.

CHART 1 NORTH POLAR SKY

Centered on the north celestial pole, this chart shows the constellations of the north polar sky. It covers the area from declination 90° at the pole, southward to declination 50°. The star Polaris, in Ursa Minor, is less than 1° from the pole and almost in the center of the chart. Polaris and the other stars around it are circumpolar; they never set below the horizon for observers in the Northern Hemisphere. How much of the sky is circumpolar depends on the observer's latitude; the amount increases the farther north you are.

